

number difference between the last packet they received and the last packet they acknowledged. This counter is used to proactively send early packet acknowledgements when a peer’s own receive window is about to close. See [Section 4.19.4.8, “Packet Acknowledgements”](#) for details.

An example scenario involving BTP receive windows is depicted in [Figure 24, “Example receive window scenario”](#), complete with packet acknowledgements as specified in [Section 4.19.4.8, “Packet Acknowledgements”](#). In this scenario, the client transmits a three-segment buffer to the server once it receives the server’s handshake request. The handshake request occupies one slot in the client’s initial receive window. The server’s initial receive window is empty. Both client and server have a maximum window size of 4.

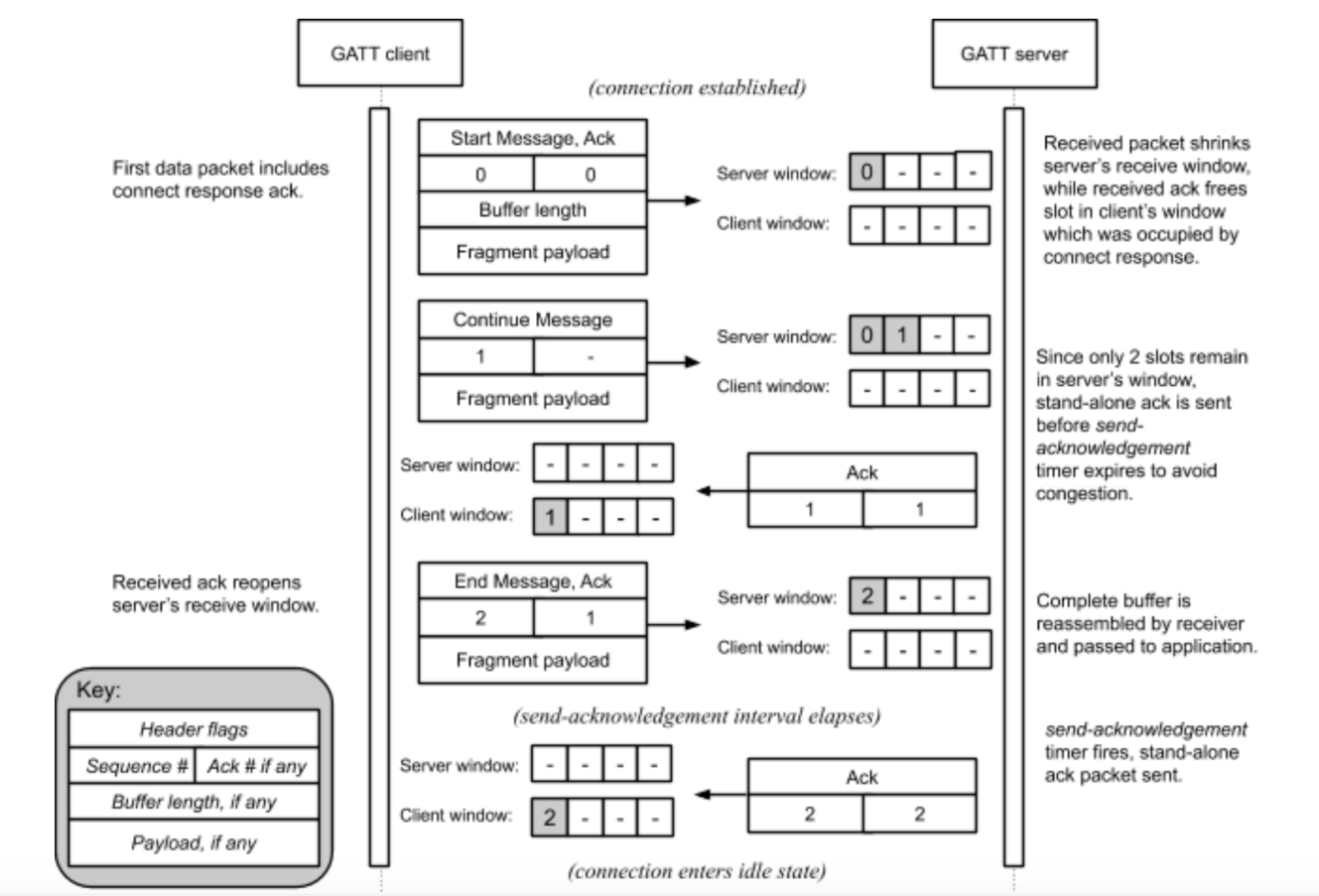


Figure 24. Example receive window scenario

4.19.4.8. Packet Acknowledgements

The purpose of sequence numbers and packet receipt acknowledgements is to support the BTP receive window and provide a keep-alive signal when a session is idle to affirm the health and continued operation of a remote BTP stack.

Per BTP Frame Formats, BTP packet receipt acknowledgements SHALL be received as unsigned 8-bit integer values in the header of a BTP packet. The value of this field SHALL indicate the sequence number of the acknowledged packet.

Acknowledgement of a sequence number indicates acknowledgement of the previous sequence number, if it too is unacknowledged. By induction, acknowledgement of a given packet implies acknowledgement of all packets received on the same BTP session prior to the acknowledged packet.